CLASS 8 — ENGLISH GULMOHAR · HARD LEVEL CHAPTER TEST SET 1

Chapter 15: **That Little Square Box** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 1 Hour 30 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 40**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–10 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 11–14 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 15–18 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 19–20 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 17 to 20.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Hard level: application and higher-order questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 10 × 1 = 10

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. Why does the author make the narrator unnamed and nervous? 1

(a) to praise his courage
(b) to link him to Flannigan
(c) so the reader can share his fears and laugh at them later
(d) to hide his identity from the police

2. Which of these shows dramatic irony? 1

(a) the captain is a spy
(b) readers sense a harmless explanation while the narrator fears death
(c) the men fear the narrator
(d) the narrator knows the truth

3. Which is a likely effect of the narrator's shout 'Stop!'? 1

(a) it hurts the pigeons **(b)** it exposes his panic to everyone on deck
(c) it wins the race **(d)** it prevents an explosion

4. Which detail best hints at the later twist? 1

(a) the ship's name
(b) the time of boarding
(c) the men's pleased smiles when the clicking is heard
(d) the colour of the lifeboat

5. Which is the best moral of the story? 1

(a) Avoid pigeons.
(b) Never travel by ship.
(c) Do not draw conclusions from partial evidence.
(d) Trust no one.

6. What does the narrator's relief at the end suggest? 1

(a) he planned the joke **(b)** he knew all along
(c) he was truly afraid for lives **(d)** he did not care

7. The expression 'letting it off' is an example of: 1

(a) rhyme **(b)** ambiguity **(c)** metaphor **(d)** alliteration

8. The countdown in the lifeboat is similar to: 1

(a) a cooking show
(b) scenes in thrillers where a bomb is about to explode
(c) a school assembly
(d) a football match

9. Why does the narrator imagine the lives of all the passengers at risk? 1

(a) it explains the voyage
(b) it makes his fear and his duty to speak seem more urgent
(c) it proves the men are sailors
(d) it shows he is a doctor

10. The narrator hesitates to inform the captain. This tells us he is: 1

(a) more afraid of ridicule than of danger **(b)** lazy
(c) careless **(d)** completely fearless

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) — 4 × 2 = 8

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

11. How does the author use ambiguity in 'letting it off'? 2

12. Why is the narrator's fear of ridicule important to the plot? 2

13. How does the author make the ending comic? 2

14. Why is the story's point of view important? 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) — 4 × 3 = 12

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

15. Discuss how the author uses small clues to build a wrong conclusion. 3

16. How does the story use contrast? 3

17. Suggest how the ending could be altered for a serious tone. 3

OR

Explain the difference between suspense and surprise in this story. 3

18. What does the story say about trust? 3

OR

How does the story reflect the saying 'look before you leap'? 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) — 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

19. 'Fear thrives where facts are missing.' Discuss with reference to the story. 5

OR

Write a short speech on 'Think before you act', using the story. 5

20. Critically appreciate 'That Little Square Box' as a humorous story with a twist. 5

OR

Imagine the captain's account of the day's events. Write it as a log entry. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER — Total: 40 Marks

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